

Day 3

**Team Aditya: Michelle Mai, Lookman Mustapha, Michael Tzitzikakis**

- Worked with Michael Tzitzikakis not in team his team was missing

**Bad Idea Exercise:**

1. Start a bad idea
2. "Yes and it also"
3. Next person starts
4. Flip them

Michelle:

1. Shoes that smell more the longer you wear them.
2. The smells can get better or worse depending on how many steps you get. The shoes also reiterate the longer you know.
3. Good: Can be used on dogs to help track them down OR hiker shoes for when they get lost.

Micheal:

1. Phone that dies every 2 minutes.
2. You have to shake it to charge it. It gets really hot when you use it for more than 2 minutes.
3. You are going against the brainrot era.

Lockman:

1. Underwear with a fart cushion in it.
2. It will make a beep noise when it hears a fart. It makes a bad smell as well.
3. Makes you avoid seating so you can walk more. #productivity

**Prompt 2:**

Act as a product designer doing divergent thinking exercises.

Take this problem and starting idea and generate business ideas.

PROBLEM: Phone that dies every 2 minutes.

STARTING IDEA: You are going against the brainrot era.

The specific problem

Why this persona cares

A simple solution concept

Likelihood this is a real, painful problem (1-10)

Prompt 1

**Prompt 1:**

Act as a product designer doing divergent thinking exercises.

Take this problem and starting idea and generate business ideas.

PROBLEM: Hikers get lost and dogs also get lost.

STARTING IDEA: Shoes that smell more the longer you wear them. The smells can get better or worse depending on how many steps you get. The shoes also reiterate the longer you know.

Generate 10 diverse problem-solution pairs. For each:

The specific problem

Why this persona cares

A simple solution concept

Likelihood this is a real, painful problem (1-10)

**Result 1:**

1. Search and rescue scent insoles

Problem: Rescue dogs lose a hiker's trail in rain or on rock.

Why they care: The first 24 hours of a search matter most.

Solution: Insoles with a unique scent, plus a matching sample left at home for rescue dogs to sniff.

Score: 6/10

2. Scent drops for off-leash dogs 

Problem: Dogs run off on trails and can't find their owner.

Why they care: Losing a dog in the woods is terrifying.

Solution: A clip on the owner's shoe drops a small scent marker every few hundred steps. The dog learns to follow it back.

Score: 7/10

3. Step reward scent (your original idea)

Problem: People lose motivation to walk.

Why they care: They want a fun, physical reward.

Solution: Shoes release a nice smell when you hit step goals and a stale smell when you sit too long.

Score: 3/10

4. Find-the-trail-again scent

Problem: Hikers step off the trail and can't find it again.

Why they care: Many lost-hiker cases start this way.

Solution: Your dog follows your own scent back to the trail.

Score: 5/10

5. Home scent kit for new dogs 

Problem: Newly adopted or recently moved dogs run away and don't know their way home.

Why they care: New dogs are the most likely to escape and get lost.

Solution: A kit that teaches the dog a "home" scent, with the same scent on the owner's shoes.

Score: 7/10

6. Group hike scent tags

Problem: Slow hikers fall behind and take the wrong path.

Why they care: Group leaders are responsible for everyone.

Solution: The leader's shoes leave a scent at trail forks, and a wristband buzzes if you go the wrong way.

Score: 5/10

7. Scent trail markers for parks

Problem: Painted trail signs are hard to see in fog, snow, or dark.

Why they care: Parks pay for rescues.

Solution: Each trail gets its own scent at junctions.

Score: 4/10

8. Insoles for people with dementia

Problem: People with dementia wander off and are hard to find.

Why they care: It's life or death, and families worry constantly.

Solution: Scented insoles plus a saved scent sample for police dogs. They work even if a GPS tracker dies or gets taken off.

Score: 9/10 (strongest idea)

9. Kid scent tags for crowded places

Problem: Kids get separated from parents at parks and campgrounds.

Why they care: Parents panic.

Solution: A scented shoe tag, with a matching sample given to venue security.

Score: 5/10

10. Shoes that smell when worn out

Problem: People keep hiking in worn-out shoes and slip.

Why they care: Worn soles lead to falls and injuries on trails.

Solution: A scent capsule breaks open when the shoe hits about 400 to 500 miles, telling you to replace it.

Score: 6/10

## Prompt 2

## Prompt 2:

Act as a product designer doing divergent thinking exercises.

Take this problem and starting idea and generate business ideas.

PROBLEM: Phone that dies every 2 minutes.

STARTING IDEA: You are going against the brainrot era.

The specific problem

Why this persona cares

A simple solution concept

Likelihood this is a real, painful problem (1-10)

## Result 1:

1. Anti-doomscroll phone for teens   
Problem: Teens scroll TikTok for hours and can't stop.  
Why they care: Parents worry about sleep, grades, and mental health. Many teens want to cut back too.  
Solution: A phone that works for 2 minutes at a time. That's enough to text or call, but not enough to fall into a feed.  
Score: 8/10
2. Bedtime phone  
Problem: People scroll in bed and lose sleep.  
Why they care: Poor sleep hurts work, mood, and health.  
Solution: After 10pm, the phone only turns on in 2-minute bursts, with a long cooldown in between.  
Score: 7/10
3. Study mode for students   
Problem: Students check their phones every few minutes while studying.  
Why they care: Grades suffer, and studying takes twice as long.  
Solution: The phone gives a 2-minute check, then locks for 25 minutes, like the Pomodoro method built into the hardware.  
Score: 7/10
4. First phone for kids  
Problem: Parents don't want to give young kids a full smartphone.  
Why they care: They want their kid to be reachable without giving them social media.  
Solution: A kids' phone that works in short bursts for calls, texts, and maps only.  
Score: 8/10
5. Addiction recovery phone  
Problem: People with gambling or social media addiction relapse through their phones.  
Why they care: Addiction wrecks their money, relationships, and mental health.  
Solution: Short sessions with no browser, so there's no room for a binge. Therapists could recommend it.  
Score: 6/10
6. Work focus phone for professionals  
Problem: Workers lose hours to "quick checks" that turn into 30 minutes.

Why they care: Their productivity and deep work suffer.

Solution: A second phone for work hours that allows 2-minute check-ins only, and saves notifications until then.

Score: 5/10

7. Social detox events

Problem: At dinners, dates, and parties, everyone is on their phone.

Why they care: People feel disconnected and want real conversation.

Solution: Venues rent out 2-minute phones, or put guest phones in lockers and hand out the short-session phone for emergencies.

Score: 4/10

8. Brainrot-free app mode

Problem: People don't want a new phone. They want less scrolling on the one they have.

Why they care: Buying a second device is expensive and annoying.

Solution: An app that shuts down your phone screen after 2 minutes of scrolling.

Unlocking it again takes effort, like walking or waiting.

Score: 7/10 (but lots of competition, like Opal and one sec)

9. Old-school style phone for adults

Problem: Adults miss life before smartphones but still need maps, texting, and two-factor codes.

Why they care: They feel their attention span is getting worse.

Solution: A simple, stylish phone that only runs essentials in short sessions. Sell it as a lifestyle and identity product.

Score: 6/10 (Light Phone already proves demand)

10. Battery as a feature, not a flaw

Problem: Phones are designed to keep you hooked as long as possible.

Why they care: People feel manipulated by apps built to be addictive.

Solution: Sell a tiny-battery phone that charges in seconds and is light and cheap.

Market the short life as the point: "It dies so you can live."

Score: 5/10

# Lean Canvases

## Lean Canvas

Prompt: Create a Lean Startup Canvas for this concept: [PROBLEM], [SOLUTION], [TARGET USER]. Fill out all 9 boxes of the Lean Canvas. Be specific and realistic. Flag any assumptions that need validation.

### 1. Scent drops for off-leash dogs ●●

Problem: Dogs run off on trails and can't find their owner. GPS collars are expensive, need charging, and lose signal in the woods. Owners don't know what to do in the first hour.

Solution: A clip on the owner's shoe drops a small scent marker every few hundred steps. It comes with a training kit and a simple web guide to teach the dog to follow the scent back.

Target user: People who hike with their dogs off-leash.

Unique value prop: A scent trail back to you that works without batteries, signal, or an app.

Unfair advantage: None at the start. Later, a scent formula we own and a community of trained dogs.

Customer segments: Off-leash hikers first, then new dog owners and breeds known to run off (huskies, beagles, hounds).

Key metrics: Training completion rate, runaway dogs that come back, refill purchases, waitlist signups.

Channels: Hiking-with-dogs subreddits and Facebook groups, dog trainers, dog parks, short videos of a dog following the trail.

Cost structure: Making the clip and scent refills, a dog trainer to design the training plan, shipping, web hosting.

Revenue streams: Kit for about \$30 to \$50, plus a refill subscription.

Assumptions to validate: Dogs can learn to follow the scent reliably. The scent lasts in rain and wind. Owners would try this before buying a GPS collar. It's a physical product, so in 6 weeks we can only build a landing page, a training guide, and a waitlist.

### 2. Anti-doomscroll phone for teens ●●

Problem: Teens scroll TikTok for hours and can't stop. Parents worry about sleep, grades, and mental health. Many teens want to cut back too.

Solution: A phone that works in 2-minute sessions. That's enough to text or call, but not enough to fall into a feed. The parent sets it up and manages it.

Target user: Parents of teens (ages 13 to 17). The parent is the buyer and the user we talk to.

Unique value prop: Your teen stays reachable without the endless scroll.

Unfair advantage: None at the start. Later, trust from parent communities and schools.

Customer segments: Parents of teens who are worried about screen time, and families giving a teen their first phone.

Key metrics: Waitlist signups, parent interviews that confirm the pain, teen screen time before and after.

Channels: Parent Facebook groups, school parent newsletters, parenting subreddits, "wait until 8th" type communities.

Cost structure: Phone hardware or a locked-down Android setup, the parent dashboard website, customer support.

Revenue streams: Phone sale, or a monthly plan for the parent controls.

Assumptions to validate: Parents would pay for this instead of using free Screen Time. Teens won't just get around it. The syllabus bans anything involving minors' data, so we should only work with parents, never collect teen data, and check with the professor. A hardware phone can't be built in 6 weeks.

### 3. Home scent kit for new dogs ●

Problem: Newly adopted or recently moved dogs run away and don't know their way home. The first few weeks are when they're most likely to escape. Shelters don't give owners much help with this.

Solution: A kit with a "home" scent for the door, the bed, and the owner's shoes. It comes with a simple 2-week web training plan and a lost dog card.

Target user: People who adopted a dog in the last 30 days.

Unique value prop: Teach your new dog what home smells like from day one.

Unfair advantage: Partnerships with shelters, so the kit comes with the adoption.

Customer segments: New adopters first, then families moving with a dog and foster owners.

Key metrics: Kits given out through shelters, how many people finish the 2-week plan, reported escapes and how many dogs came back.

Channels: NYC shelters and rescues, adoption events, new dog owner subreddits, pet stores.

Cost structure: Making the scent product, packaging, the training website.

Revenue streams: Kit for about \$25 to \$35, plus a bundle price for shelters.

Assumptions to validate: A trained scent actually helps a lost dog get home. Shelters would hand it out. New owners worry about their dog running off early enough to buy it. It's a physical product, so the 6-week version is the web training plan plus a small test batch.

### 4. Study mode for students ●

Problem: Students check their phones every few minutes while studying. A quick check turns into 20 minutes of scrolling. Screen Time limits are easy to turn off.

Solution: A web app that runs 25-minute focus blocks with 2-minute phone breaks.

Unlocking early costs effort, like waiting 60 seconds. It has study rooms where you can see friends' streaks.

Target user: College students during midterms and finals.

Unique value prop: The Pomodoro method, enforced. You get a 2-minute check, then your phone is locked for 25 minutes.

Unfair advantage: Friends studying together makes it spread, and our first users are our own classmates.

Customer segments: College students first, then grad students and people studying for

the LSAT or MCAT.

Key metrics: Weekly users, focus blocks completed, streak length, invites sent.

Channels: Campus group chats, library flyers, clubs and study groups, "study with me" TikToks.

Cost structure: Hosting, our build time, the \$100 ad budget.

Revenue streams: Free, with a \$3 a month paid version for stats and study rooms.

Assumptions to validate: A web app can't really lock a phone, so we may need a browser extension or native app. Students will keep using it instead of deleting it. It's a crowded space (Opal, one sec, Forest), so we need a clear reason people would pick ours.

Top Two Idea

## Top Two Ideas

### 1. Scent drops for off-leash dogs ●●

Problem: Dogs run off on hiking trails and can't find their way back to their owner. GPS collars cost a lot, need charging, and often lose signal in the woods.

Who has it: People who hike with their dogs off-leash, especially new dog owners and owners of breeds that like to run off, like huskies, beagles, and hounds.

Why they'd care: Losing a dog in the woods is terrifying. Owners want a simple backup that works without batteries or signal and helps their dog find its own way back.

### 2. Study mode for students, as a social app ●

Problem: Students pick up their phones every few minutes while studying. A quick check turns into 20 minutes of scrolling, and Screen Time limits are easy to turn off.

Who has it: College students, especially during midterms and finals.

Why they'd care: Studying takes twice as long and grades suffer. Studying alone makes it easy to give in. This is a social app: you join a study room with friends, everyone locks their phone for 25 minutes, and you all get a 2-minute break together. Your friends can see if you unlock early, and you build streaks as a group. It works because students don't want to be the one who breaks the streak.